

Making a multi-brand automotive group easy to understand, trust and engage with

MAHY Khoory Automotive | Website experience rebuilt from scratch

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Project snapshot

Client	MAHY Khoory Automotive (MKA), part of the M.A.H.Y Khoory Group
Market	UAE
Scope	Website UX/UI design and development, built from scratch
Status	Vercel staging, client review. Positive feedback on the direction; no formal approval claimed
Live structure reviewed	Homepage; About Us, News & Insights, Careers, Get In Touch in the main navigation; brand links to Dongfeng, OMODA JAECOO and Pre-Owned

A note on evidence. This document explains design reasoning. It contains no invented research, quotes or metrics. The homepage screenshot used here comes from an earlier iteration (its navigation and headline differ from the current staging build); I flag where that matters. Other staging pages were not captured as screenshots, so I describe them from the live structure rather than show them.

The problem was never just "make it look better"

MKA's previous website converted poorly. Early in the project we identified its visual quality and overall experience as an important contributing factor. It did not communicate the professionalism, scale, credibility and corporate maturity that MKA wanted from its digital presence. I treat it as a contributing factor, not the only cause. We had no data isolating one reason.

The client asked for a site that looks aesthetically strong, feels premium and corporate, represents the organisation properly, showcases its brands, improves navigation, creates clearer journeys and gives people better reasons to enquire.

The more useful question was this:

How can the website use UX, information architecture and visual design to make MAHY Khoory Automotive easier to understand, trust and engage with?

Visual credibility and conversion are linked through a chain. If a site looks unconvincing, trust drops. Without trust people explore less, and without exploration there is little intent to act.



Figure 1. The reasoning chain that guided the project. It is a hypothesis for design, not a measured finding.

What the previous site did not do

It did not help a first-time visitor answer a simple sequence of questions: who is MKA, which brands does it represent, why should I trust it, where do I go next, and how do I get in touch? The redesign is organised around that sequence.



Figure 2. The question hierarchy the architecture has to answer, in order.

An experience rebuild, not a reskin

Because nothing was inherited, every structural decision was open: site architecture, navigation, homepage hierarchy, how the parent company relates to its brands, CTA placement, contact flows, trust signals, News, Careers, Pre-Owned, the footer and the visual system. Reskinning would have kept the old assumptions. Starting again let us ask what each page was for before deciding how it looked.

Six UX challenges

Challenge	What it demanded
1. Communicating MKA clearly	Visitors must grasp what MKA is before they enter any brand.
2. Multi-brand architecture	The relationship between MKA and its brands must be obvious, not assumed.
3. Establishing trust	A corporate automotive group has to signal scale, legitimacy and legacy.
4. Corporate vs automotive	Corporate without being dull; automotive without turning promotional or chaotic.
5. Conversion	Clear paths toward meaningful actions, not one lonely button.
6. Different intents	New vehicle, pre-owned, service, company info and contact are different goals and need different routes.

These six pulled in different directions. A stronger corporate voice can weaken automotive emotion; more conversion prompts can erode premium restraint. Most of the later decisions are trade-offs between them (see page 11).

Parent first, brands second, actions last

MKA is an organisation with several brands and business areas, not a single marque. If a visitor lands on the group site and cannot tell the parent from its brands, they either leave or click into the wrong place. The architecture therefore runs from the broadest idea to the most specific action.

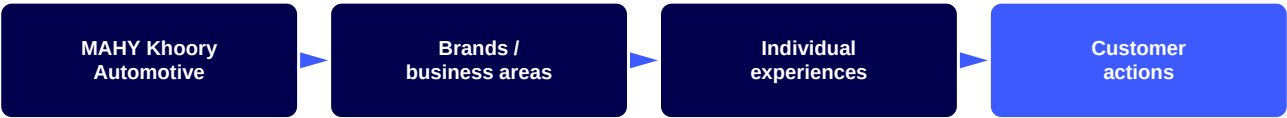


Figure 3. Core hierarchy. The parent explains and reassures; brands and experiences carry the detail; actions close the loop.

What the staging site actually does

Layer	Observed on staging
Parent	Homepage framed around MKA and its legacy; About Us in the main navigation.
Brands	"Official distributor for two global marques" section: Dongfeng, OMODA JAECOO, plus a Pre-Owned card. Brand cards link out to the brands' own sites.
Corporate content	News & Insights and Careers as top-level destinations.
Actions	Get In Touch in the navigation, a "Learn more" link, and a Careers CTA.

Keeping the main navigation short (four items) is a deliberate reduction. The group site is a gateway and a corporate home, so detailed vehicle browsing lives on the brand sites. This prevents the parent site from competing with its own brands. The cost is that a visitor wanting a vehicle makes one extra hop. I judged that acceptable, and it is one of the things to validate after launch.

Open item: the Pre-Owned entry currently has no destination on staging (its link is a placeholder). I am flagging it rather than presenting it as finished.

Reading the homepage as a journey

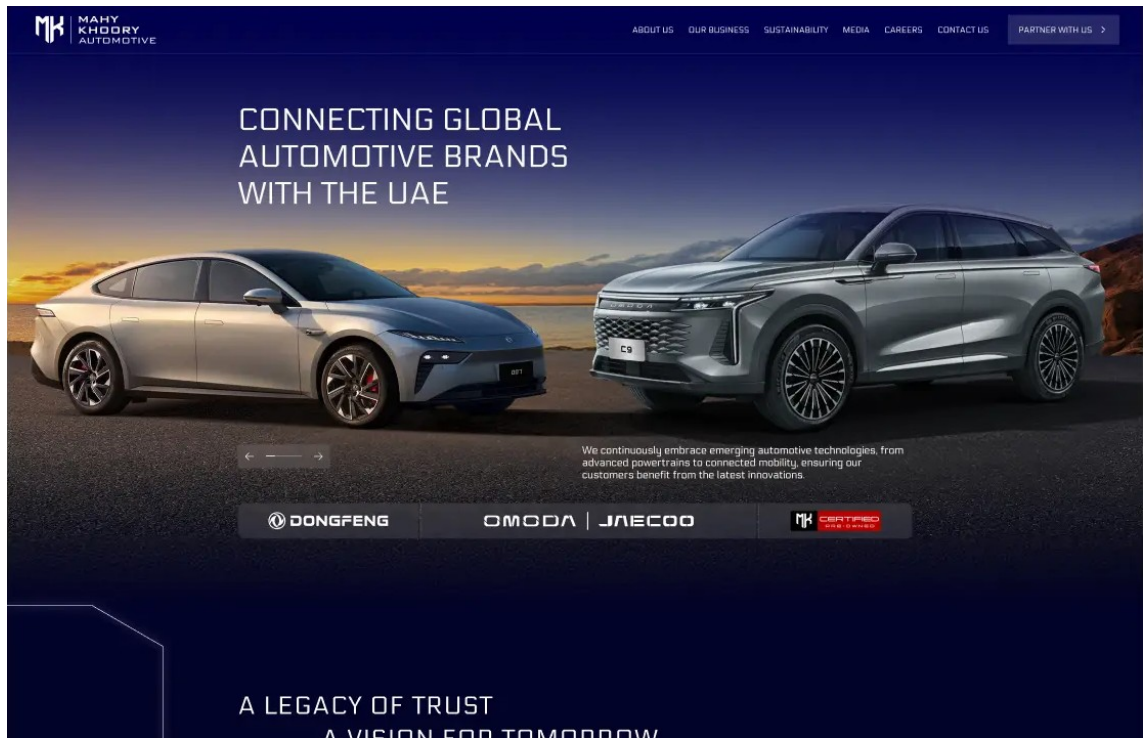


Figure 4. Earlier homepage iteration (from the supplied screenshot). Headline, two vehicles in a landscape setting, and a brand strip (Dongfeng, OMODA | JAECCO, Certified Pre-Owned) all appear above the fold. The current staging build uses a different headline and video; the brand-first logic has carried through.



Figure 5. The intended homepage progression.

Stage	Question	What the page does
Identity	Who is MKA?	Opening headline and a video hero, followed by "A Legacy of Trust, Driving What's Next" with MKA's group heritage.
Brand discovery	What does MKA represent?	Dongfeng, OMODA JAECCO and Pre-Owned shown with lineup imagery.
Scale	How established?	"Our reach across the UAE": showrooms, team size, nationalities, years of family legacy (animated counters; I do not quote figures).
Content / Action	What is happening? What next?	Company highlights linking to News; Careers invitation; Get In Touch.

Ordering matters. People who understand the organisation first browse brands with more confidence. Scale comes after brands because numbers mean more once you know what is being counted.

What the visual system is for

The client wanted something aesthetically strong and corporate. I treated that as a UX requirement because visual quality is the first trust signal a visitor receives, before they read anything.

Decision	What it accomplishes
Deep navy palette with restrained accent	Reads as corporate and established, and lets vehicle imagery supply the colour and emotion.
Wide, technical uppercase headlines	Gives an automotive, engineered tone and establishes hierarchy at a glance.
Generous spacing and large scale	Signals premium quality and keeps sections scannable instead of crowded.
Large full-width imagery	Sets emotional context immediately, before the detail.
Light motion (animated MK monogram, counters, video)	Adds energy without competing with the content. Motion should be checked for performance and accessibility before launch.
Brand strip with consistent logo treatment	Presents unlike brands as one family, so none looks bolted on.

Automotive imagery has to carry the message

Images were chosen for what they say, not for how attractive they are. A beautiful photograph that says the wrong thing weakens the section it sits in.

Message	Imagery that supports it
Performance	Dynamic movement, road context
Aerodynamics	Profile views, close vehicle details
Technology	Cockpit, interface, technology details
Capability	Vehicle stance in its environment
Luxury / comfort	Interior, materials, passenger experience

The hero shows vehicles at dusk on open ground. That sets a mood of travel and confidence, which suits a headline about connecting brands with the UAE.

Trust is accumulated, not declared

A single About page cannot carry credibility. I spread trust signals across the journey so a visitor meets reassurance at each stage:

Signal	Where it appears on staging
Group heritage	Legacy section on the homepage; About Us
Brand relationships	"Official distributor" section
UAE presence and scale	Reach section: showrooms, team, nationalities, legacy
Aftersales and parts	Mentioned in the legacy copy and site description (dedicated service pages not captured here)
Activity and people	News & Insights, Careers
Contact transparency	Email, Dubai address and social links in the footer

Journeys for different intents



Vehicle discovery. Happens on the brand sites; MKA routes people there.



Test drive. Also depends on brand-site CTAs.



Corporate discovery. Fully supported on the group site.



Careers. A top-level destination.



Pre-Owned. Entry exists; destination still to be completed on staging.



Service. Intended path; confirm dedicated content before launch.

Conversion as a whole journey

I did not treat conversion as "put a CTA near a form". A visitor who does not understand or trust the organisation will ignore a well-placed button.

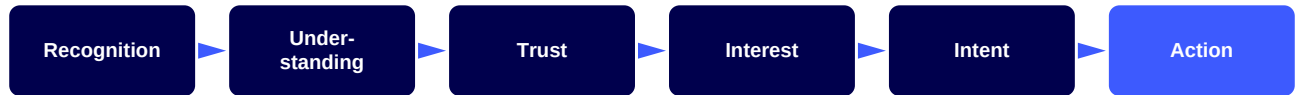


Figure 6. Each stage earns the next. Design effort goes to the early stages as much as to the final one.

Contact and forms

Get In Touch is in the main navigation on every page, with email, address and social links in the footer. The contact experience should be designed around enquiry type (vehicle enquiry, test drive, sales, service, Pre-Owned, general). The aim is to minimise friction while collecting just enough to route the enquiry to the right team. I have not reviewed the final form fields for this document, so I describe the principle rather than claim a specific form.

Pre-Owned is its own journey

A pre-owned buyer worries about availability, price, condition and trustworthiness, which differ from a new-car buyer's concerns. Burying Pre-Owned inside new-vehicle browsing would hide it. The homepage therefore gives Pre-Owned a card equal to the two main brand entries, with its own certified identity. The destination page is the next piece to complete.

News, Careers and the footer

News & Insights

News is more than a content block. Launches, events, partnerships, milestones and industry participation make the organisation feel active. A homepage "Company Highlights" strip links to the full News page so the evolving story is visible from the first screen.

Careers

MKA is also an employer. A Careers destination, with its own homepage invitation ("Be part of something bigger"), shapes how the whole organisation is perceived, and it speaks to people as well as buyers.

The footer as navigation

The footer is organised into Our Brands (Dongfeng, OMODA | JAECOO, Pre Owned), Explore (Careers, News & Insights) and Contact (email, address, LinkedIn, Instagram). The bottom of the page therefore offers a next step instead of ending. One gap: the footer does not list About Us or Get In Touch, which are in the header. I would consider adding them.

Balancing four things at once

The design was refined over several rounds covering structure, visual exploration, content changes, image selection, section refinement, responsive behaviour, implementation and review. The screenshot with a different headline and navigation is evidence of that evolution. I am not stating iteration counts or testing sessions because I have no records to support specific numbers, and no formal user testing took place.

Quality	Meaning	Risk if over-weighted
Corporate	Structured, professional, credible	Generic and lifeless
Premium	Refined, spacious, sophisticated	Style over clarity
Automotive	Dynamic, emotional, visually strong	Promotional, chaotic
Usable	Clear and easy to navigate	Plain and forgettable

The goal was never to maximise one. It was to find a balance where each keeps the others honest.

Example trade-offs

A short navigation keeps the parent site clean but sends vehicle browsing to external brand sites. Large imagery and motion add emotion but cost performance. Brand-first ordering clarifies the portfolio but pushes enquiry paths lower on the page than a sales-led layout would.

What we still need to learn

The redesign answers a known conversion problem, but its impact has not been validated. There is not enough production data to say whether conversion improved. The following is a recommended plan for after launch, not a set of results.

Area	Measure
Conversion	Contact submissions, test-drive enquiries, sales enquiries, phone clicks, messaging interactions, Pre-Owned enquiries
Behaviour	Homepage engagement, brand selection, vehicle-page engagement, CTA interaction, form abandonment, scroll depth, navigation usage
Business quality	Qualified leads, lead follow-up, test-drive completion, lead-to-sale progression

Limitations

The site is on staging. The client has not approved public portfolio use. There are no post-launch data, so commercial impact is unproven. Positive feedback on the direction has been received, but I do not claim formal approval. This case study documents UX reasoning and process, not measured business success. Not every page was captured visually here, and some staging content (such as Pre-Owned) is placeholder-level.

Reflection

The project began with a business problem: low conversion and a website that did not convey the credibility MKA wanted. Rather than changing the visual style, we rebuilt the experience from scratch, focusing on clarity, credibility, brand hierarchy, customer journeys, visual storytelling and conversion opportunities.

The design problem has been addressed. The UX system has been built. The business outcome is still waiting to be measured.

What I would do next: finish the Pre-Owned destination, confirm the contact and enquiry routing, add About Us and Contact to the footer, and set up the measurement plan before launch so the first weeks of data are usable.